The Two-Verse Dhāraṇī

Gāthādvitīyadhāraṇī · Toh 918 · Derge Kangyur
ཚིགས་ས་བྱུང་པ་གཉིས་པའ་གཟུངས།

The Two-Verse Dhāraṇī, known in Sanskrit as the Gāthādvitīyadhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Tshigs su bcad pa gnyis pa'i gzungs, is a brief dhāraṇī text that opens with homage to the youthful Mañjuśrī. Its two verses name the obscurations that hinder sentient beings, such as contempt for the Buddha and the Dharma, laziness, complacency, desire, pride, remorse, and unsteady conduct, and they present the supreme vehicle as the antidote through which these faults are entirely abandoned. A short Sanskrit mantra follows, and the text then promises that anyone who applies the dhāraṇī, whether through its words or its meaning, will gain ten kinds of benefit, including a well-nourished constitution and a favorable passing at the time of death. It is Toh 918 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the collected dhāraṇī texts, the incantations valued for their protective and purifying power.

In the language of India: gāthādvitīyadhāranī
In the language of Tibet: The Two-Verse Dhāraṇī

Homage to the youthful Mañjuśrī.

Contempt for the Buddha and the Dharma,
laziness, contentment with a little,
indulgence in desire and in pride,
remorse, and wavering conduct:
these are the obscurations of sentient beings.
As their antidote the supreme vehicle is taught,
and through it every fault
of those hindrances is utterly abandoned.

tadyathā oṃ vajraprakāra vajraprakāra vajracakra daṃṣṭābhayanake amale vimale nirmale culuke culuculu sarvabuddhe svāhā

Whoever applies the Two-Verse Dhāraṇī
by way of its words or its meaning,
that excellent being endowed with intelligence
will obtain ten kinds of benefit.
All one's elements will be fully nourished;
at the time of death one attains the highest, sublime joy;

one is born just as one wishes;
in every life one remembers one's former lives;
one meets the buddhas,
and likewise hears the supreme vehicle from them;
one gains devotion together with understanding;
one obtains the two doors, and swiftly attains awakening.

The Two-Verse Dhāraṇī is complete.

Translator's Notes

• The title "□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□" could also be read as "the second verse." It is rendered here as "two-verse," following the sense of a dhāraṇī framed by verses. The list of obscurations corresponds to a known Yogācāra list: contempt for the Buddha and Dharma, laziness, contentment with little, conduct of desire and of pride, remorse, and the conduct of those who are not yet settled in a vehicle. "Wavering conduct" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) translates this last item, the conduct of the "undetermined."

"The two doors" (□□□□□□□□) is not explained in the text. It most likely refers to the two gateways of dhāraṇī and samādhi. It could also refer to the word and meaning mentioned just before, but this is uncertain.

The ten benefits do not divide cleanly as written. "Devotion together with understanding" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) may count as two items, or the two doors may count as two.

The khams (elements) that are nourished are presumably the bodily constituents, but the text does not say "of the body."

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.